

Sara Costa

Sarasota, FL | sarasignedin@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/sara-risotti | github.com/sarasignedin | papaya.kiwi
Active Secret Clearance

Target Role

Security Engineer, Offensive Security

Summary

Security consultant with 7+ years of client-facing experience across cloud security, vulnerability analysis, and remediation engineering in AWS, Azure, and GCP environments. Proven record delivering enterprise assessments, translating technical findings for non-technical stakeholders, and driving remediation plans aligned to business priorities. Patent-pending inventor and BSides speaker with hands-on Python and Terraform automation experience.

Technical Skills

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker

Security & CNAPP: Prisma/Cortex Cloud, Wiz, XSOAR, XSIAM, Splunk, Cribl, CSPM, DSPM, CWPP, CIEM, PKI, Computer Forensics

IaC & Automation: Terraform, Python, Bash

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, C#, JavaScript, HTML/PHP, SQL

Data & Analytics: MS SQL Server, Oracle, AppDynamics, DataRobot, Quantum Metric, KNIME

Protocols & Systems: TCP/IP, HTTP, DNS, SMTP, Windows/Linux APIs and system-call familiarity

Experience

Founder & Cloud Security Consultant

Papaya Kiwi Consulting LLC

Nov 2025 – Present

Remote, USA

- Lead security engineering engagements across 2 major cloud runtime surfaces (Kubernetes and Docker) and approximately 10+ client environments, focused on risk identification, hardening, and remediation execution.
- Built prompt-to-pipeline remediation workflows that can reduce manual remediation steps by up to 40% when automated security control fixes are approved for apply.
- Filed USPTO Provisional Patent #64/022,497 for a dual-agent advisory method that converts natural-language remediation intent into structured execution workflows.
- Presented at BSides South Florida 2026 (Technical Track): *From Prompt to Pipeline: How Dual-Agent Method Automates Cloud Security Remediation.*

Consultant (Private Subcontractor – Professional Services for PANW)

Palo Alto Networks Services Ecosystem

Aug 2024 – Oct 2025

Remote, USA

- Served as primary SME for CSPM and DSPM programs spanning 3 major clouds (AWS, Azure, GCP) across approximately 12 enterprise environments, identifying control gaps and remediation priorities.
- Analyzed vulnerability findings, authored client-facing reports, and delivered stakeholder debriefs focused on risk, impact, and corrective actions.
- Integrated Prisma Cloud findings into Splunk to improve vulnerability visibility, triage workflows, and incident-response context.
- Automated remediation-oriented workflows with Python and Terraform, reducing manual remediation steps by approximately 40% and improving response consistency.

Security Consultant

BxC Security

Sept 2022 – Feb 2024

Germany

- Conducted security posture and vulnerability gap analysis across 2 enterprise cloud platforms (AWS and Azure) for approximately 8 client assessments, producing prioritized remediation roadmaps.

- Assessed privileged access management controls and documented risk-treatment plans for enterprise stakeholders.
- Designed corporate PKI architecture and authored technical documentation to support secure operational processes.

US Army Reserves – Information Technology Specialist (25B), Signal Support Systems Specialist (25U), Human Intelligence Collector (35M)
 United States July 2021 – Present
Part Time

- Provided technical support to 50+ personnel in classified and unclassified environments with emphasis on secure communications and operational reliability.
- Manage NIPR/SIPR Cisco switch configuration and maintenance for mission-critical network operations.

Software Developer / Data Scientist
 BENTELER Group Mar 2019 – June 2020
Paderborn, Germany

- Built IoT software and KPI dashboards using Python, SQL, and Oracle across 2 enterprise database platforms (MS SQL Server and Oracle), tracking 15+ operational KPIs.
- Contributed across planning, development, and testing with C/C++, C#, and JavaScript in production systems.

Speaking & Projects

- BSides South Florida 2026 Speaker: *From Prompt to Pipeline: How Dual-Agent Method Automates Cloud Security Remediation.*
- Patent-Pending AI System: USPTO Provisional #64/022,497 (Dual-Agent advisory and remediation method).
- Google SecOps (Chronicle) workshop challenge: investigated a pre-ingested dataset representing a full attack chain against a fictitious organization across 18 challenges, including raw log search, UDM field navigation, script block forensics, lateral movement tracking, and obfuscation analysis.
- Challenge performance: 1,800 points, 121st place, and 16/18 challenges solved within the CTF window.
- Additional cloud security project work and tooling references available at github.com/sarasignedin.

Certifications and Education

Certification: CompTIA Security+ ce
M.S., Cyber Technology
B.S., Network Security
A.S., Cyber Security

University of Maryland Global Campus, 2024
 LSU Shreveport, 2019
 SUNY Westchester Community College, 2017